

NATHANIEL MAY

Engineering Manager
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EXPERIENCE

Ditto

Engineering Manager

Aug 2024 – Present

- Managed 16 direct reports and one manager in a fully remote environment.
- Led four distinct teams responsible for different layers of the stack: the cross-platform Rust library; all 12 SDKs; the query language, execution, and storage layers; and the CI/CD, DevOps, and QA infrastructure for the whole engineering department.
- Built a new hiring pipeline from the ground up in less than 60 days. Increased interview throughput by 10× and reduced time to hire by 50% across all engineer and manager positions.
- Scaled the hiring pipeline by designing training for new interviewers, introducing shadowing, eliminating reliance on third-party sourcing, and by personally conducting over 50 interviews in under a year.
- Oversaw the successful, on-time delivery of two new SDKs, Flutter and Kotlin Multiplatform, by quickly involving contractors to accelerate and win four new deals with Fortune 100 companies.
- Founded a new department-wide mentorship program and provided training for mentors which accelerated professional development and strengthened relationships across team boundaries.
- Oversaw the integration of agentic development practices with Cursor, Claude, and Copilot AIs.

dbt Labs

Engineering Manager

May 2022 – Feb 2024

- Managed four direct reports on the Adapters team who built and maintained open-source adapters in Python for Snowflake, Google BigQuery, Amazon Redshift, Postgres, and Apache Spark.
- Expanded the dbt ecosystem by working with partners including Snowflake, Databricks, Google, and Microsoft with input from product, developer experience, OSS users, and enterprise customers.
- Led incident response and prioritized followthrough and fixes to minimize disruptions for dbt Cloud customers and to increase uptime and other key reliability metrics for the system.
- Accelerated the engineering hiring pipeline by creating a new systems architecture interview for staff engineers and by conducting nearly 100 interviews evaluating both technical and management skills.
- Fostered professional development across teams by introducing monthly lightning talks, assisting the mentorship program, forming long-term coaching relationships, and delivering trainings on coaching.

Senior Software Engineer

Feb 2021 – May 2022

- Improved performance of dbt Core with a new static parser powered by tree-sitter and Rust, reducing file parse times by a factor of 1000—from 300ms to 300µs—enabling customers to scale their projects to thousands more models without additional overhead.
- Enabled dbt Labs to release the 1.0 stable version of the product by leading a team of engineers to build a new subsystem for structured logging, allowing programmatic access to internal state both by internal cloud teams and external developers.

Fauna

Engineering Manager

Jan 2020 – Dec 2020

- Led four direct reports on the Queries and Drivers team who were responsible for core product functionality: maintaining open-source drivers across six languages, a GraphQL extension, and modules within the core database including the query language, authentication, authorization, and indexing.
- Increased predictability and efficiency of the engineering department by pioneering live team tracking dashboards in Jira, introducing async team stand-ups, conducting an engineering-wide consolidation of synchronous meetings, standardizing code review practices, and starting release-based retrospectives across all four engineering teams.
- Led incident response and followthrough to increase system uptime for FaunaDB customers.

Senior Software Engineer

Jan 2019 – Jan 2020

- Grew the Fauna Query Language by adding new functions and runtime semantics in Scala.
- Reduced the maintenance burden for client developers by designing a new query versioning system to guard against semantic changes in new cloud database versions.
- Increased product resiliency by improving distributed systems tests in Scala for the core database.
- Increased client developer productivity by reducing index build times from minutes to seconds and comprehensively improving error readability.

iRobot

Senior Software Engineer

Sep 2018 – Jan 2019

- Sped up development time and reduced operating costs for creating new serverless microservices and data pipelines by developing a general purpose Scala library to replace Python infrastructure.

MongoDB

Consulting Engineer

Aug 2015 – Mar 2018

- Grew relationships between MongoDB and customers by traveling weekly to over 50 companies.
- Assisted external clients by firefighting production incidents, planning engineering roadmaps, teaching courses, and advising technical leads on data resiliency, optimization, and scalability.

Red Hat

Consulting Engineer

Sep 2013 – Aug 2015

SKILLS

- Hiring Pipelines
- Project Management
- Technical Documentation
- Databases
- Coaching
- Data Analytics
- Customer Empathy
- Distributed Systems

LANGUAGES

- Rust
- Haskell
- Scala
- PureScript
- Python
- TypeScript
- Javascript
- Java

EDUCATION

University of Massachusetts Amherst

2013

B.S. Computer Science, Mathematics | AI Research